

Lisa Simons

Business Analysis + Product Thinking + Information Architecture + Consulting

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Contact me if you are looking to quickly establish an effective framework and requirements that enable your delivery teams to implement products that meet customer and user needs.

I'm an expert in Business Analysis practices, having delivered technical requirements and operational designs on more than 20 projects. My specialty is in adapting deliverables for enterprise-level projects to ensure business and product objectives are met. I naturally enjoy connecting the dots between products, technology and people.

Areas of Expertise

Business Analysis

- Business Analyst team leadership
- Business analysis techniques & practices
- Agile Product Owner deliverables
- Issue, risk & change management

Product Thinking

- Product management principles in practice
- As Is & To Be assessments
- Product definitions & strategic alignment

Information architecture

- Project frameworks & governance
- Service blueprints & operational design
- Systems engineering & data requirements
- Enterprise standards & workspace design

Consulting

- Consulting insights & recommendations
- Solution proposals & options evaluation
- Stakeholder & senior leadership engagement

Professional Experience

[Brainmates](#) | Sydney

2009 - Present

Senior Business Analyst Consultant

- **Cross-industry insights.** Engaged across a broad portfolio of projects over an extended consulting career in a variety of industries, including: payments, banking, education, contact centres, and government.
- **Data governance.** Redesigning an enterprise's workspaces to better support consistent ways of working across newly integrated product and technology teams. Defined a new shared information architecture and taxonomy, which was used to reorganise 20+ SharePoint sites (60k+ folders, 270k+ files) and 16 Confluence sites.
- **Payments expertise.** I have deep domain knowledge in Australian payments, in particular the NPP scheme (Osco, PayTo, PayID). Served as Product Owner for banking and financial services clients, ensuring the backlog of user stories complied with payment scheme rules.
- **Large, complex environments.** Defined all the rules that the bank / credit union customers of a financial services provider have to meet in order to participate in each of the Australian payments schemes. This was a significant, multi-year project involving more than 20 key documents, with 50 to 200 pages of requirements and guidance in each document.
- **Business, technical and data requirements.** Delivered the requirements needed for the sales, enrolment, student services, and academic governance teams for multiple projects with a private education provider. This included defining the requirements for bespoke online applications and off-the-shelf systems (Salesforce).
- **Product thinking.** Contributed to the development of Brainmates' [Essentials of Product Management](#) course.
- **Policy alignment.** Documented and provided confirmation that the operational processes followed by a call centre customer support team met its data privacy compliance obligations.
- **Operational improvements.** Created a service blueprint mapping the full customer lifecycle, from awareness to offboarding, which gave a banking organisation a framework to track process and technology improvements.

Professional Experience (continued)

Telstra BigPond | Sydney

2003 - 2009

Requirements Team Lead

- Led the BigPond Requirements Team (10 to 17 business analysts).
- Responsible for the requirements delivered by the team for a major initiative integrating BigPond's IT platforms with a new Telstra CRM system, which included migrating more than 1 million customer accounts.
- Ensured all team deliverables complied with the constraints of the many BigPond IT systems, and also met the sales, billing, and customer support business rules.

Senior Business Analyst

- Delivered use cases for incremental improvements to the BigPond online sign-up workflow.
- Provided clear, visual models for Network Engineering initiatives, which enabled business stakeholders to understand the complex project impacts on their work.
- Initiated updates to operational processes, including customer support and Telstra.com website content admin.

netdecisions | London, UK

2000 - 2002

Head of London Systems Analyst Group

- Contributed to the development and rollout of the organisation's software development methodology.
- My role involved defining team responsibilities and practices, allocating work to the team, reviewing deliverables, interviewing candidates and conducting performance appraisals.

Systems Analyst / Team Lead

- Defined and communicated requirements to development teams and testers for multiple projects.
- I was responsible for project estimates, planning, change management, and issue resolution.

OTEN (TAFE), Sydney Water, BHP, Western Power

Pre 2000

Electrical Engineer (Control Systems)

- Delivered database and control system solutions for infrastructure, education, and industry.
- Updated Student Administration and Management (SAM) system forms and processes.

Education

- Master of Engineering Management | UTS, Sydney.
- Bachelor of Engineering (Honours)(Electrical) | UNSW, Sydney.